

PROJECT BRIEF

A digital platform for the branch.

Where the project is now, what we are building, and how it gets finished.
Written for everyone in this group — nothing technical.

The problem, in one paragraph

A degree tells an employer what you studied. It does not tell them what you turned up for, what you built, or what you led. Right now everything NiMechE-SF does — the webinars, the plant visits, the competitions, the projects — happens, ends, and leaves almost no trace. Attendance lives in a notebook. Certificates are PDFs in a WhatsApp thread. Nobody can check whether any of it is real.

That is the gap. Not a website — a **record**.

WHAT WE ARE BUILDING

A platform where everything you do through the branch adds up to a professional record you can show an employer — and keep after you graduate. You attend things; the certificates, the skills and the history build themselves.

Three things it has to do

FOR MEMBERS

Find what is on, register in two taps, and earn certificates that arrive on their own — with a code an employer can check years later.

FOR THE EXECUTIVE

Run an event end to end from a phone, including taking attendance at the door with no network, and issue a whole cohort's certificates in one action.

FOR EMPLOYERS AND PARTNERS

See what the branch actually does, verify a certificate without creating an account, and send us a placement without signing up for anything.

Four stages, in order.

No dates in this document on purpose. What matters is the order, and that we do not skip a stage to feel like we are moving faster.

1

Design MOSTLY DONE

Decide what every screen looks like and how it behaves *before* anyone writes code. The public site, joining, the member dashboard and the executive dashboard are drawn, on both desktop and phone, in light and dark. This is the cheapest place to change your mind, which is exactly why we are asking for your opinion now rather than later.

2

Build the beta NEXT

Turn the designs into a working platform. Not everything — the core: joining and membership approval, events and registration, attendance capture, certificates and verification, the opportunities hub, and the photo and video gallery.

3

Pilot it on real events

Run two or three actual branch events on the platform with a small group, and watch what breaks. Something always does, and it is never the part you expected. Fix that, then open it up.

4

Open it to the whole branch

Everyone joins, everything runs on it. After that come the things we have deliberately left out of the beta: mentorship matching, public member profiles, CV export, digital membership cards.

THE GOAL

Finish the beta before we resume school. Not the whole platform — the beta. Something real enough to run a live event on in the first weeks of the session.

What “beta” means, honestly.

In the beta

- The public site, including a gallery of photos and video from events, projects and competitions
- Joining, and executives approving new members
- Events: publishing, registering, reminders
- Attendance capture that works with no network
- Certificates that issue automatically, and public verification
- Skills that build from what you actually did
- The opportunities hub
- The executive dashboard and basic analytics

Deliberately not yet

- Mentorship matching
- Public member profile pages
- CV and portfolio export
- Digital membership cards
- Dues or payments of any kind
- A separate mobile app — the site works properly on a phone, which is enough

These are not cancelled. They are the reason the beta can be finished at all.

A few things we have already decided

Not to shut down discussion — so you know what has been thought about, and can push back on it specifically.

- **No passwords.** You sign in with a link we email to your Tech-U address. Nothing to forget.
- **Signing up is four fields.** Name, Tech-U email, department, level. We never ask which school you attend — your email already says.
- **You never claim a certificate.** Finish the programme and it arrives, in your email and your profile.
- **You never fill in your own skills.** They build from what you attended and what you built, which is what makes them worth showing.
- **Every photo album is attached to the event it came from,** so a picture always leads back to the programme.

What we need from you.

RIGHT NOW, ONE THING

Look at the designs and tell us what is wrong with them. Confusing wording, a missing screen, something that would not survive contact with a real event — all of it is useful, and all of it is far cheaper to fix now than after it is built.

Where we could use hands

BUILD

Anyone who writes code, or wants to learn on something real. You do not need to be good yet. You need to be around.

DESIGN

Reviewing screens, improving the ones that are weak, and eventually the certificate artwork.

WORDS AND PICTURES

Photographing events properly, writing up projects and competitions, keeping the gallery from going stale after launch.

TESTING

Using it before it is good and saying exactly where it annoyed you.
Genuinely one of the most valuable roles here.

OPENING DOORS

Contacts at companies for placements, and help getting the departments to share their student lists — which would make approving members almost instant.

NOT SURE?

Say so in the group. There is more than enough that does not need a particular skill.

One last thing, plainly: this only works if it is **easier** than the WhatsApp group it replaces. Every design decision has been made with that test in mind — and if something we show you fails it, that is exactly what we want to hear.